A Lightweight Gaussian Sampler for Smart Contract Virtual Machines

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Abstract

Smart-contract applications can benefit from non-uniform randomness, but major blockchain virtual machines typically expose raw cryptographic primitives or uniform randomness interfaces rather than a lightweight Gaussian sampler. This paper presents a practical Gaussian sampler for smart-contract virtual machines built from the population count, equivalently the Hamming weight, of an n-bit VM-native output. The method is simple: obtain an n-bit hash or randomness value, count the 1's in the output, standardize that count, and represent the result as an integer-scaled Gaussian approximation suitable for deterministic VM arithmetic. Under an independent Bernoulli bit model with heterogeneous marginals, the bit count is Poisson-binomial and Lyapunov's central limit theorem implies asymptotic normality of the standardized count; a corollary gives the explicit condition under which the fixed normalization $(n/2, \sqrt{n}/2)$ used on-chain inherits that limit. The paper combines the probabilistic argument with empirical evaluation. It presents a detailed `keccak256` study at $n = 256$ and a cross-VM expansion covering Keccak-256 and SHA-256 alongside an iid fair-bit control at $n = 256$ and $n = 512$ that also serves as a reference model for Sui native randomness. Across the tested settings the hash primitives are statistically indistinguishable from the control on every diagnostic: the summed bit bias shifts the standardized output by at most 0.02 standard deviations, the ratio of the observed popcount variance to the independence-implied variance lies within 0.988–1.017, the Kolmogorov–Smirnov distance to the exact binomial law is below 0.012 at 10^4 draws and below the 5% critical value at 10^6 draws, the two-sided tails agree with the binomial law through $z = 4$, and repeated-primitive output sequences show no short-lag structure. Measured on the EVM, the full transform costs about 530 gas per draw with a constant-time population count. The result is a lightweight Gaussianization layer for blockchain VMs, especially for ecosystems such as EVM and Solana that expose hash primitives but no native Gaussian sampling interface, and for Sui as a Gaussian layer over native uniform randomness.

Keywords: smart contracts; on-chain randomness; Gaussian sampling; Hamming weight; Poisson-binomial distribution; central limit theorem; EVM; Solana; Sui

Highlights

- Popcount of a VM-native hash yields a Gaussian draw with integer arithmetic only.
- Lyapunov-CLT justification with explicit conditions for the $(n/2, \sqrt{n}/2)$ scaling.
- Keccak-256 and SHA-256 match an iid fair-bit control on every diagnostic tested.
- Tails match the exact binomial law through $z = 4$ at 10^6 draws per target.
- Full transform costs about 530 gas on the EVM with a constant-time SWAR popcount.

1 Introduction

Many blockchain applications can usefully consume Gaussian-like random values rather than only uniform ones. Examples include probabilistic pricing mechanisms, game mechanics, Monte Carlo style on-chain simulation, and mechanism-design components that need a smooth bell-shaped perturbation rather than a flat discrete draw. Yet smart-contract virtual machines generally expose either raw cryptographic primitives or uniform randomness interfaces, not a native Gaussian sampling primitive. This broader randomness gap has long been recognized in the smart-contract literature, which treats deterministic execution as a core obstacle for probabilistic applications [3, 22].

That gap matters because standard Gaussian transforms fit poorly in deterministic blockchain execution. Floating-point arithmetic is unavailable or awkward, trigonometric transforms are expensive, and rejection-based methods can be difficult to reason about in constrained execution environments. A useful VM-native Gaussian sampler therefore needs to be simple, integer-based, portable across execution environments, and cheap enough to embed directly in smart contracts or on-chain programs.

This paper studies one such construction. Given an n-bit VM-native output, let S_n denote the number of 1's in its bits. If those bits behave like approximately independent Bernoulli variables with success probabilities near 0.5, then the standardized bit count should be close to a Gaussian law. The resulting transform is computationally minimal: obtain an n-bit output, compute its popcount, normalize by the natural mean and standard deviation, and emit an integer-scaled value for on-chain use.

The scope of the paper is deliberately narrow. It does not claim to generate entropy by itself, and it does not attempt a cryptographic proof about the internal structure of the underlying hash function or randomness service. Entropy can come from external VRFs, beacon randomness, or native randomness services [2, 8, 13, 15]. The paper focuses on the *on-chain Gaussianization layer*: the deterministic transform that turns a VM-native output into a practical Gaussian-like sample.

The paper combines the probabilistic argument and the empirical study into one continuous presentation. Its goal is to justify the transform under a clearly stated probabilistic model and to evaluate whether the observed finite-sample behavior of representative VM-native outputs is compatible with that model. The paper makes five contributions. First, it formalizes a VM-native Gaussianization transform that requires only an n-bit output, a population count, and integer scaling. Second, it gives a probabilistic justification under a heterogeneous Bernoulli model, where the Hamming weight follows a Poisson-binomial law and Lyapunov's theorem supplies the asymptotic normal limit; a corollary isolates the one genuinely empirical condition, on the *sum* of the bit biases, under which the fixed on-chain normalization inherits that limit. Third, it evaluates the finite-width behavior of the transform through bit-bias, dependence, normality, tail, and repeated-output diagnostics, calibrated against an iid fair-bit control run through the identical pipeline. Fourth, it shows how the same construction transfers across EVM, Solana, and Sui-style randomness interfaces. Fifth, it measures the execution cost of the transform on the EVM and shows that a constant-time population count makes the whole draw cost a few hundred gas.

2 Related Work

Randomness on blockchains is usually studied at the entropy-source or protocol layer rather than at the distribution-shaping layer considered here. Classical VRFs formalize verifiable pseudorandom outputs [13], while recent blockchain work studies how to expose or consume randomness safely in

deterministic smart-contract environments [3, 22]. In practice, smart-contract developers often rely on oracle-backed VRF systems or protocol-provided beacon randomness rather than attempting to create entropy inside the VM itself [2, 8, 15].

This paper addresses a narrower problem. It does not compete with VRFs, commit–reveal systems, or beacon-randomness mechanisms as an entropy source. Instead, it assumes that an unpredictable seed already exists and asks a different question: how should a contract or on-chain program convert a VM-native output into a lightweight Gaussian-like sample without floating-point machinery or rejection sampling?

That distribution-shaping problem is separate from the standard question of how to obtain entropy on-chain. Conventional Gaussian samplers such as the Box–Muller transform [1] and the Ziggurat method [12] rely on floating-point transforms, transcendental functions, table lookups, or rejection loops; Devroye [4] surveys this classical toolkit, including the old observation that a sum of independent Bernoulli or uniform variables is approximately Gaussian by the central limit theorem. Those tools are natural in ordinary software, but they are less attractive inside deterministic VM execution, where arithmetic, reproducibility, and bounded cost matter.

A closer neighbor is the literature on sampling the *discrete* Gaussian over the integers, which lattice-based cryptography has developed into integer-only, table-driven, and constant-time samplers [6, 9, 10, 14]. Those samplers are exact or provably close to a target discrete Gaussian and are designed for adversarial settings, but they carry precomputed tables, multi-word arithmetic, or data-dependent control flow, and they consume many uniform bits per output. The construction studied here sits at the opposite end of that trade-off: it is intentionally austere, using only a VM-native bit string and its Hamming weight, and it accepts a lattice-valued approximation with resolution $2/\sqrt{n}$ standard deviations in exchange for a fixed instruction count and no tables. It does not compete with the cryptographic samplers on exactness; it competes on what can be embedded in a smart contract at negligible cost.

The probabilistic core of the method is closer to the theory of sums of independent but non-identically distributed Bernoulli variables. Under the heterogeneous-bit model used here, the popcount has a Poisson-binomial law, and the practical question is whether the empirical mean and variance remain close enough to the canonical $(n/2, \sqrt{n}/2)$ normalization for fixed digest widths. Hong [7] gives a standard modern reference for the Poisson-binomial setting used throughout this paper, while Durrett [5] provides the central-limit-theorem background behind the Lyapunov argument.

The empirical side of the paper also sits in an established testing tradition. Statistical batteries such as NIST SP 800-22 and TestU01 are useful as early diagnostics, while not constituting cryptographic certification by themselves [11, 17]. This paper does not rerun those batteries; its claim is narrower, namely that the Hamming weight of the tested primitives behaves like the Hamming weight of fair independent bits, and the diagnostics are chosen to probe exactly the failure modes that would break that claim. At a more local level, binary-sequence similarity and association measures such as Rogers–Tanimoto and Sokal–Michener remain useful for checking whether bit structure looks materially different from fair-coin baselines before collapsing outputs to scalar popcounts [16, 18].

3 Cross-VM Applicability

The construction in this paper should be read as a *Gaussianization layer* for VM-exposed cryptographic primitives. The entropy source itself is outside the scope of the paper. In practice, that source could come from beacon randomness, native randomness services, or external systems such

as VRFs. Once a VM makes a suitable unpredictable seed available, the contribution of this paper is to transform that seed into a lightweight on-chain Gaussian-like draw [2, 8, 15].

Under that framing, EVM, Solana, and Sui play different roles.

EVM. EVM chains are the primary target. Solidity exposes the relevant hash functions directly, and modern EVM chains also expose `block.prevrandao` as a randomness input. What the VM does *not* expose is a native Gaussian random primitive. This makes the present method a direct fit for Ethereum and EVM-compatible chains [8, 21].

Solana. Solana is the strongest non-EVM target. The SVM exposes native hashing syscalls including SHA-256, Keccak-256, and BLAKE3 (the last is listed for completeness; the numerical study evaluates Keccak-256 and SHA-256, which are the primitives shared with the EVM). At the same time, Solana's programming model remains deterministic and does not provide native on-chain randomness in the same sense as a built-in random object; developers are pushed toward VRF-style integrations for entropy. This makes the proposed transform attractive as a lightweight Gaussian sampler once an external entropy source has been imported [19, 20].

Sui. Sui differs from the previous two systems because it already provides native on-chain randomness through `Random` and `RandomGenerator`. However, the documented API is aimed at generating uniform values and values in explicit ranges. It does not document a native Gaussian or normal-distribution primitive. Therefore Sui is still a meaningful target for this method, not because it lacks randomness altogether, but because it still lacks an equally lightweight native Gaussian sampler layered on top of its native randomness service [15].

VM	Native primitive	Randomness status	Role in this paper
EVM	Keccak-256, SHA-256	no native Gaussian primitive	primary target
Solana	SHA-256, Keccak-256, BLAKE3	external entropy needed	primary target
Sui	RandomGenerator	native randomness exists	Gaussian layer target

Table 1: Target selection for the cross-VM version of the method.

4 Generator Construction

Let H_n be an n-bit value produced by a VM-native primitive. Write its output bits as

$$X_{n,1}, X_{n,2}, \ldots, X_{n,n},$$

where $X_{n,i} = 1$ if the i-th bit is 1 and $X_{n,i} = 0$ otherwise. Define

$$S_n = \sum_{i=1}^{n} X_{n,i},$$

the count of 1's in the digest. This statistic is the population count, or Hamming weight, of the output bit string.

The natural Gaussian approximation used throughout this paper is

$$Y_n = \frac{S_n - n/2}{\sqrt{n}/2}.$$

Because smart-contract VMs do not natively support floating-point arithmetic, the contract-level output can instead be represented at integer scale c by

$$Z_{n,c} = \mathrm{round}(cY_n).$$

Two concrete examples are especially relevant here.

1. For a 256-bit primitive, such as Keccak-256 or SHA-256,

$$Y_{256} = \frac{S_{256} - 128}{8},$$

and with $c = 1000$ this becomes the exact integer formula

$$Z_{256,1000} = 125 S_{256} - 16000.$$

2. For a 512-bit primitive or a 512-bit randomness sample,

$$Y_{512} = \frac{S_{512} - 256}{8\sqrt{2}},$$

so the scale factor $1000/(8\sqrt{2}) = 88.388348\ldots$ is irrational and cannot be applied exactly in integer arithmetic. The practical remedy is to absorb the irrational constant into a larger integer scale. With $c = 10^6$ the multiplier is $10^6/(8\sqrt{2}) = 88388.35\ldots$, and

$$Z_{512,10^6} = 88388\,(S_{512} - 256)$$

is a pure integer formula with relative scale error 4×10^{-6} and no division. If the 10^3 scale is preferred, $\lfloor (88388\,(S_{512} - 256) + 500)/1000 \rfloor$ recovers $\mathrm{round}(1000\,Y_{512})$ except when $1000\,Y_{512}$ lies within 0.09 of a half-integer, since $|88.388348 - 88.388| \cdot 256 < 0.09$.

When multiple values are needed, the generator can be iterated by repeated hashing. Starting from a seed,

$$H_{n,1} = \mathcal{P}(\mathrm{seed}), \qquad H_{n,t+1} = \mathcal{P}(H_{n,t}),$$

where $\mathcal{P}$ is the selected VM-native primitive, and each output is derived from the corresponding popcount

$$S_{n,t} = \sum_{i=1}^{n} X_{n,t,i}.$$

Algorithm 1 states the one-shot transform in the form in which it is implemented.

Algorithm 1 Popcount Gaussianization of a VM-native output

Require: seed x (VRF output, beacon value, or native randomness); width n; integer scale c

$H \leftarrow \mathcal{P}(x)$ ▷ VM-native primitive: Keccak-256, SHA-256, or a native uniform draw

$S \leftarrow \mathrm{popcount}(H)$ ▷ Hamming weight; constant-time SWAR reduction

$Z \leftarrow \mathrm{round}\big(c\,(S - n/2)\,/\,(\sqrt{n}/2)\big)$ ▷ $125S - 16000$ for $n = 256$, $c = 1000$

return Z ▷ for a sequence, reuse H as the next seed

5 Probabilistic Model

The strongest defensible probabilistic model for this construction is not the exact iid Bernoulli(0.5) model. Instead, let

$$X_{n,1}, \ldots, X_{n,n}$$

be independent Bernoulli random variables with bit-specific success probabilities

$$\mathbb{P}(X_{n,i} = 1) = p_{n,i}.$$

The values $p_{n,i}$ are allowed to vary with i and need only be close to 0.5 in practice.

Under this model,

$$S_n = \sum_{i=1}^{n} X_{n,i}$$

has a Poisson-binomial distribution, with mean and variance

$$\mu_n = \sum_{i=1}^{n} p_{n,i}, \qquad \sigma_n^2 = \sum_{i=1}^{n} p_{n,i}(1 - p_{n,i}).$$

The natural standardized count is therefore

$$Z_n = \frac{S_n - \mu_n}{\sigma_n}.$$

The numerical study in this paper is intended to support, not prove, the use of this model. In particular, it looks for empirical evidence against strong bit-level bias, simple cross-bit dependence, simple input-output dependence, and short-lag dependence in repeated-hash output sequences.

6 Lyapunov-CLT Justification

Theorem 1. *Suppose that for each n, the family*

$$X_{n,1}, \ldots, X_{n,n}$$

consists of independent Bernoulli random variables with success probabilities $p_{n,1}, \ldots, p_{n,n}$. Assume there exists a constant $\varepsilon \in (0, 1/2)$ such that

$$\varepsilon \le p_{n,i} \le 1 - \varepsilon$$

for all relevant n and i. Then the standard Lyapunov condition holds for $\delta = 1$, and

$$\frac{S_n - \mu_n}{\sigma_n} \xrightarrow{d} \mathcal{N}(0, 1) \qquad \text{as } n \to \infty.$$

Proof. For a Bernoulli random variable,

$$\mathbb{E}\left[|X_{n,i} - p_{n,i}|^3\right] = p_{n,i}(1 - p_{n,i})^3 + (1 - p_{n,i})p_{n,i}^3.$$

The right-hand side is maximized at $p_{n,i} = 1/2$, so

$$\mathbb{E}\left[|X_{n,i} - p_{n,i}|^3\right] \le \frac{1}{8}.$$

Hence

$$\sum_{i=1}^{n} \mathbb{E}\left[|X_{n,i} - p_{n,i}|^3\right] = O(n).$$

On the other hand,

$$p_{n,i}(1 - p_{n,i}) \ge \varepsilon(1 - \varepsilon),$$

so

$$\sigma_n^2 = \sum_{i=1}^{n} p_{n,i}(1 - p_{n,i}) \ge n\varepsilon(1 - \varepsilon).$$

Therefore

$$\sigma_n^3 \geq (n\varepsilon(1-\varepsilon))^{3/2},$$

and the Lyapunov ratio is

$$\frac{1}{\sigma_n^3}\sum_{i=1}^{n}\mathbb{E}\left[|X_{n,i}-p_{n,i}|^3\right] = O(n^{-1/2}) \to 0.$$

Lyapunov's central limit theorem then gives the claim. □

The theorem standardizes by the model quantities (μ_n, σ_n), whereas the on-chain transform standardizes by the fixed constants $(n/2, \sqrt{n}/2)$. The two agree only if the bit biases are small in a specific aggregate sense, and it is worth being precise about which sense, because the hypothesis of the theorem alone does not deliver it. Writing

$$p_{n,i} = \frac{1}{2} + e_{n,i}, \qquad B_n = \sum_{i=1}^{n} e_{n,i}, \qquad Q_n = \sum_{i=1}^{n} e_{n,i}^2,$$

gives

$$\mu_n = \frac{n}{2} + B_n, \qquad \sigma_n^2 = \frac{n}{4} - Q_n.$$

Corollary 1. *Under the hypotheses of the theorem,*

$$\frac{S_n - n/2}{\sqrt{n}/2} = \sqrt{1 - \frac{4Q_n}{n}}\,\frac{S_n-\mu_n}{\sigma_n} \;+\; \frac{2B_n}{\sqrt{n}}.$$

Consequently, if $B_n/\sqrt{n} \to 0$ and $Q_n/n \to 0$, then

$$\frac{S_n - n/2}{\sqrt{n}/2} \xrightarrow{d} \mathcal{N}(0,1).$$

The two conditions are also necessary in the sense that a non-vanishing $B_n/\sqrt{n}$ shifts the location of every subsequential limit and a non-vanishing Q_n/n shrinks its scale.

Proof. The identity is algebra: $S_n - n/2 = (S_n - \mu_n) + B_n$ and $\sigma_n/(\sqrt{n}/2) = \sqrt{1-4Q_n/n}$. Under the stated conditions the first factor converges to 1 and the additive term to 0, so Slutsky's theorem combined with the theorem gives the limit. □

The corollary makes the division of labor explicit. The uniform bound $\varepsilon \leq p_{n,i} \leq 1-\varepsilon$ in the theorem is not sufficient for the practical normalization: the family $p_{n,i} \equiv \frac{1}{2} + e$ with any fixed $e \neq 0$ satisfies it, yet gives $2B_n/\sqrt{n} = 2e\sqrt{n} \to \infty$. What is needed is that the biases cancel on average, $B_n = o(\sqrt{n})$. The scale condition, by contrast, is nearly automatic: it is second order in the biases, and any uniform bound $|e_{n,i}| \leq \eta$ forces $\sqrt{1-4Q_n/n} \geq \sqrt{1-4\eta^2}$. At $n = 256$ and $\eta = 0.02$, which is the order of the largest bit bias observed later, this scale factor is at least 0.9992 regardless of the data, while the centering shift $2B_n/\sqrt{n} = B_n/8$ could in principle be as large as 0.64 standard deviations. The finite-width empirical question is therefore almost entirely about B_n, and the numerical study reports it directly, in standardized units, as $(\hat{\mu} - 128)/8$.

In the two concrete widths studied later in the paper, this gives

$$(\mu_{256}, \sigma_{256}) \approx (128, 8) \qquad \text{and} \qquad (\mu_{512}, \sigma_{512}) \approx (256, 8\sqrt{2}),$$

with the quality of the approximation governed by B_n as just described.

7 Numerical Study Design

The numerical study separates one-shot behavior from recursive generator behavior. The one-shot experiments are designed to stress different ways in which simple input structure might survive the VM primitive. Sequential `uint256` values test ordered numeric inputs, shifted `uint256` values test high-bit changes, strings of the form `Transaction Number: i` test formatted message-like inputs, shifted transaction strings test the same format under a large offset, and two random ASCII families test unstructured variable-length inputs with lengths 2 to 7 and 2 to 32. Each family contains 10,000 hashes.

The diagnostics are organized around the ways the construction could fail. Bit-wise empirical means test marginal balance. Pairwise similarity and correlation statistics test simple cross-bit structure before the output is collapsed to a scalar count. Block-popcount correlations then aggregate the digest into non-overlapping 16-bit blocks and check whether the Hamming weights of those blocks move together. This is closer to the statistic used by the sampler than a bit-pair test alone. Input-bit correlations in the sequential families test whether input order or low-complexity input structure remains visible after hashing. Bit-level autocorrelations up to lag 30 test short-range structure across ordered outputs. Finally, the popcount diagnostics test the actual quantity consumed by the generator: the centering, scaling, CDF, QQ behavior, and tail behavior of the Hamming weight. Two features of these popcount diagnostics deserve emphasis. First, the ratio of the observed popcount variance to the variance implied by the estimated marginals under independence is reported as a dependence check at the level of the statistic the sampler consumes. Second, distributional distances are reported both against the continuous $\mathcal{N}(128, 8^2)$ benchmark and against the exact Binomial$(256, \frac{1}{2})$ law, so that the unavoidable lattice discrepancy can be separated from any discrepancy caused by the bits themselves.

Every "maximum" statistic in the study is an extreme over hundreds or thousands of correlated tests, and its size under the null is not obvious by inspection. The expanded study therefore runs the identical pipeline on an iid fair-bit control generated by a conventional software generator, which supplies the null reference against which the hash primitives are judged.

To study the recursive generator directly, the paper also evaluates four repeated-hash chains of length 10,000, started from representative integer and string seeds. These chains test the use case in which successive outputs are produced by iterating the primitive rather than by hashing unrelated inputs. For these chains the study records popcount autocorrelation, lag-1 scatter, runs-test z-scores, and tail error relative to the Gaussian benchmark.

8 Expanded Multi-VM Study

The expanded study evaluates the construction at the level of *VM-exposed primitives* rather than chain labels alone. This choice separates the statistical behavior of the digest or randomness interface from ecosystem-specific naming. The study covers Keccak-256 and SHA-256 as hash primitives shared across EVM and Solana environments. It also includes two *fair-bit control* targets at 256 and 512 bits, whose bit strings are drawn from a conventional software generator (Mersenne Twister) rather than from any VM. These control rows play two roles. They are the iid fair-bit null model run through the identical pipeline, so every maximum statistic reported for the hash primitives can be compared with the value the same statistic takes when independence and fairness hold by construction. They are also the natural reference model for a Gaussianization layer over Sui's `RandomGenerator`, whose documented contract is to deliver uniform bytes. They are not a production audit of Sui's live randomness service.

Keeping a generic n-bit representation is important because it preserves the same normalization template

$$\frac{S_n - n/2}{\sqrt{n}/2}.$$

This keeps the probabilistic framing unchanged even when concrete VMs expose different widths.

For each target, the study repeats the same statistical diagnostics used in the original Keccak-256 analysis. It estimates bit-wise bias and the implied normalization constants $(\hat{\mu}, \hat{\sigma})$, checks pairwise binary-sequence similarity and correlation, tests input-output correlation for structured families, measures bit-level autocorrelation, compares the popcount CDF, QQ behavior, and tails against the Gaussian benchmark, and evaluates repeated-primitive output sequences. The pairwise binary-sequence diagnostics are particularly important because Rogers-Tanimoto, Sokal-Michener, and phi-correlation act as structure-sensitive checks on binary outputs before they are collapsed into a scalar popcount [16, 18].

Figure 1 summarizes the worst observed centering deviation, scaling deviation, Kolmogorov-Smirnov distance, and two-sided tail error at $z = 2$ across the expanded cross-VM targets. Table 2 reports the same values explicitly. The main pattern is that the hash primitives are indistinguishable from the fair-bit control. At $n = 256$ the worst centering error is 0.171 for Keccak-256, 0.092 for SHA-256, and 0.098 for the control; the worst Kolmogorov-Smirnov distance to the continuous normal is 0.036, 0.032, and 0.035 respectively; the worst tail error at $z = 2$ is 0.014, 0.008, and 0.009; and the worst bit bias is 0.019, 0.017, and 0.018. Keccak-256 is marginally the most extreme target on three of these four axes, but by margins that are well inside the run-to-run variation one expects from a maximum over 256 or 10,000 correlated quantities, and SHA-256 sits on the other side of the control. The 512-bit control shows the expected shrinkage with width: its worst Kolmogorov-Smirnov distance is 0.025 and its worst tail error is 0.005.

Primitive	n	$\lvert\Delta\mu\rvert$	$\lvert\Delta\sigma\rvert$	KS	$\lvert\Delta T_2\rvert$	Max $\lvert\rho_h\rvert$
Keccak-256	256	0.1708	0.0004	0.0363	0.0141	0.0354
SHA-256	256	0.0924	0.0004	0.0323	0.0079	0.0286
Fair-bit control (256-bit)	256	0.0977	0.0004	0.0348	0.0092	0.0253
Fair-bit control (512-bit)	512	0.1482	0.0006	0.0246	0.0048	0.0218

Table 2: Summary diagnostics for the expanded multi-VM study. The sequence column reports the largest absolute autocorrelation observed in repeated-output chains up to lag 30.

Figure 2 shows that the corresponding dependence diagnostics tell the same story. The worst bit-level autocorrelation up to lag 30 is 0.044 for Keccak-256, 0.052 for SHA-256, and 0.041 and 0.045 for the two controls; the SHA-256 value is the largest single dependence statistic in the study, and it exceeds the control by less than the spread between the two controls themselves. The worst repeated-sequence lag-1 correlation is 0.018 for Keccak-256, 0.023 for SHA-256, and 0.017 for the 256-bit control, and the worst sequence autocorrelation up to lag 30 is 0.035, 0.029, and 0.025. In the 512-bit control the worst lag-1 correlation is 0.008 and the worst sequence autocorrelation is 0.022.

The pairwise similarity measures remain highly stable across the tested targets. Table 3 shows that the mean Rogers-Tanimoto similarity equals its fair-coin value 1/3 and the mean Sokal-Michener similarity equals its fair-coin value 1/2 to four decimals for every target, and that the largest observed absolute phi-correlation is 0.041 for Keccak-256, 0.046 for SHA-256, and 0.041 and 0.044 for the controls. The two similarity indices are monotone transforms of the same match count and are reported for comparability with the classical fair-coin baselines; the phi-correlation

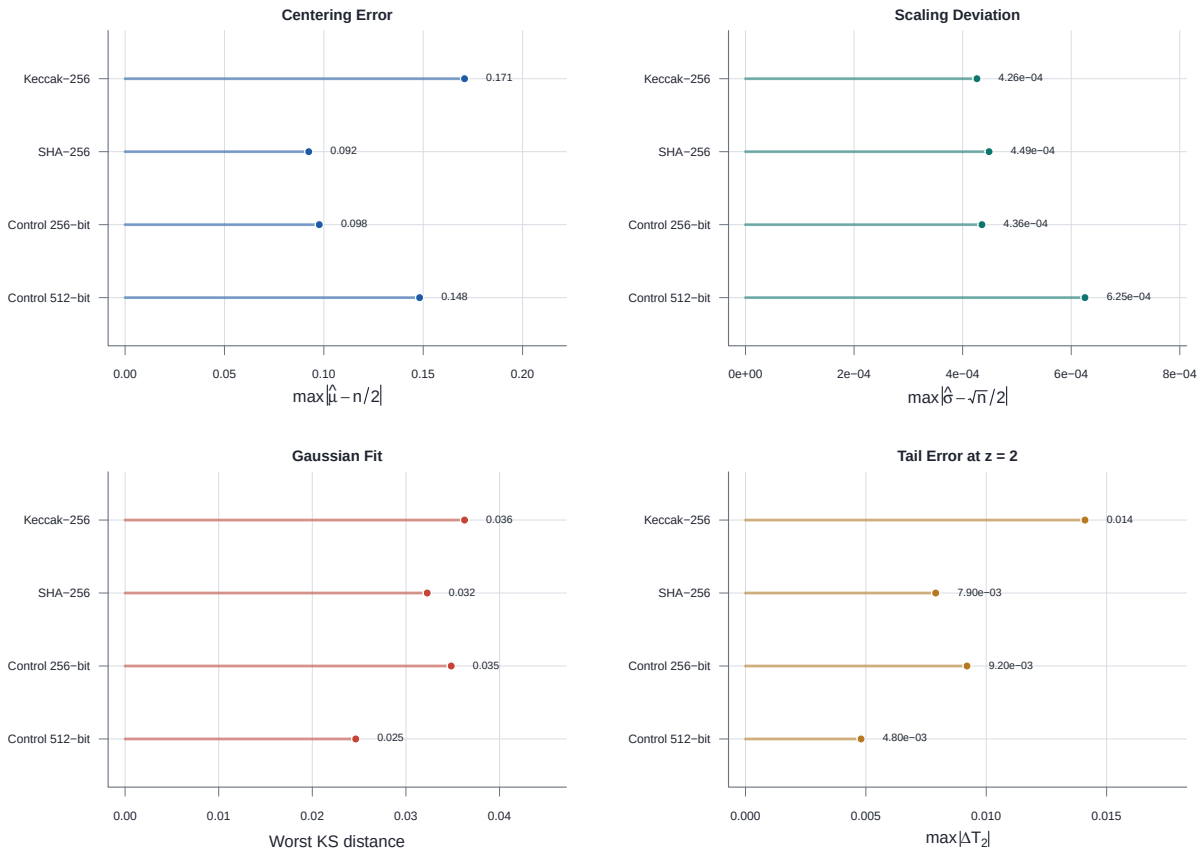


Figure 1: Cross-VM summary of worst normalization and Gaussian-fit diagnostics across the tested primitives and widths.

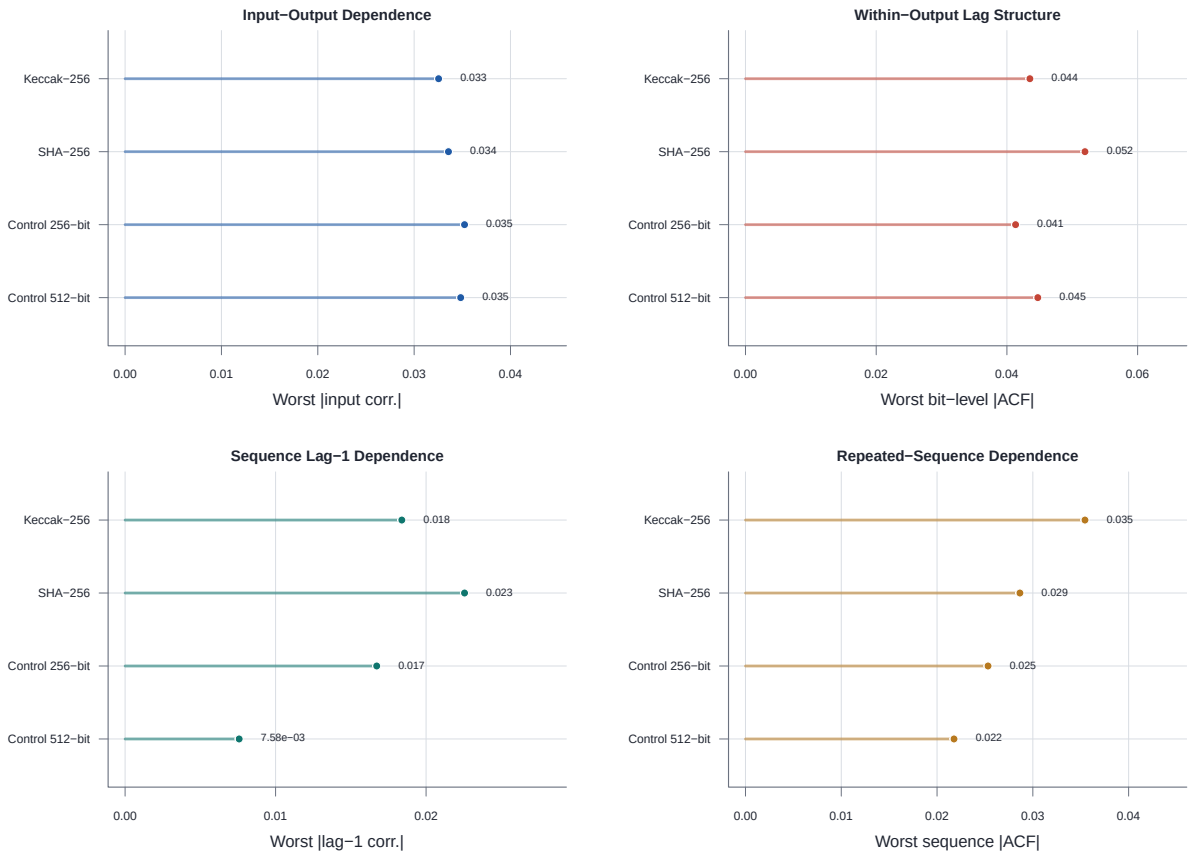


Figure 2: Cross-VM summary of input-output, within-output, and repeated-sequence dependence diagnostics.

carries the pairwise information, and on that statistic the hash primitives again fall within the range spanned by the controls.

Primitive	Mean RT	Mean SM	Mean $\lvert\phi\rvert$	Max $\lvert\phi\rvert$
Keccak-256	0.3333	0.5000	0.0080	0.0408
SHA-256	0.3333	0.5000	0.0079	0.0461
Fair-bit control (256-bit)	0.3333	0.5000	0.0079	0.0410
Fair-bit control (512-bit)	0.3333	0.5000	0.0079	0.0441

Table 3: Pairwise binary-sequence similarity and correlation diagnostics for the baseline sequential family in the expanded multi-VM study.

9 Uniformity and Dependence Diagnostics

Figure 3 shows the empirical mean of each bit with Bonferroni-adjusted bands. Across all six input families, the bit-wise probabilities remain close to 0.5 and do not show an obvious positional pattern. In the current run, the largest observed absolute deviation $|\hat{p}_i - 0.5|$ lies between roughly 0.014 and 0.019 across the six families. Exactly one of the $6 \times 256 = 1{,}536$ bit means falls outside its band: bit $\hat{p}_i = 0.5192$ in Experiment 1.1, at $z = 3.84$ against a per-family Bonferroni threshold of $z = 3.73$. Each family has a 5% chance of producing at least one such exceedance under the null, so one exceedance among six families is unremarkable, and the corresponding maximum for the fair-bit control in the expanded study, 0.018, is of the same size.

Figure 4 shows pairwise similarity and phi-correlation diagnostics for all $\binom{256}{2}$ bit pairs in the baseline sequential integer experiment. The phi-correlation distribution is centered near zero, and the similarity measures stay close to their fair-coin baselines. This is useful evidence against simple pairwise dependence, though not a proof that higher order dependence is absent.

The next dependence check groups each 256-bit digest into 16 non-overlapping 16-bit blocks and computes the Hamming weight of each block. If higher-order structure were present in a way that directly affects the popcount statistic, one possible symptom would be correlation among these block-level weights. Table 4 reports the mean and maximum absolute correlation across the $\binom{16}{2}$ block pairs for each one-shot family. The mean absolute block correlation remains below about 0.009, and the largest observed absolute block correlation is about 0.033. This does not prove block independence, but it adds a statistic-level dependence check beyond individual bit pairs.

Experiment	Mean block $\lvert r\rvert$	Max block $\lvert r\rvert$
Experiment 1.1	0.0072	0.0263
Experiment 1.2	0.0082	0.0302
Experiment 2.1	0.0069	0.0309
Experiment 2.2	0.0073	0.0325
Experiment 3.1	0.0083	0.0268
Experiment 3.2	0.0074	0.0283

Table 4: Correlation diagnostics for Hamming weights of 16 non-overlapping 16-bit blocks within each 256-bit output.

Figure 5 studies whether simple input order survives hashing in the sequential families. The observed input-bit correlations fluctuate tightly around zero with no persistent structure by bit position. In this run, the largest absolute input-bit correlation is about 0.033.

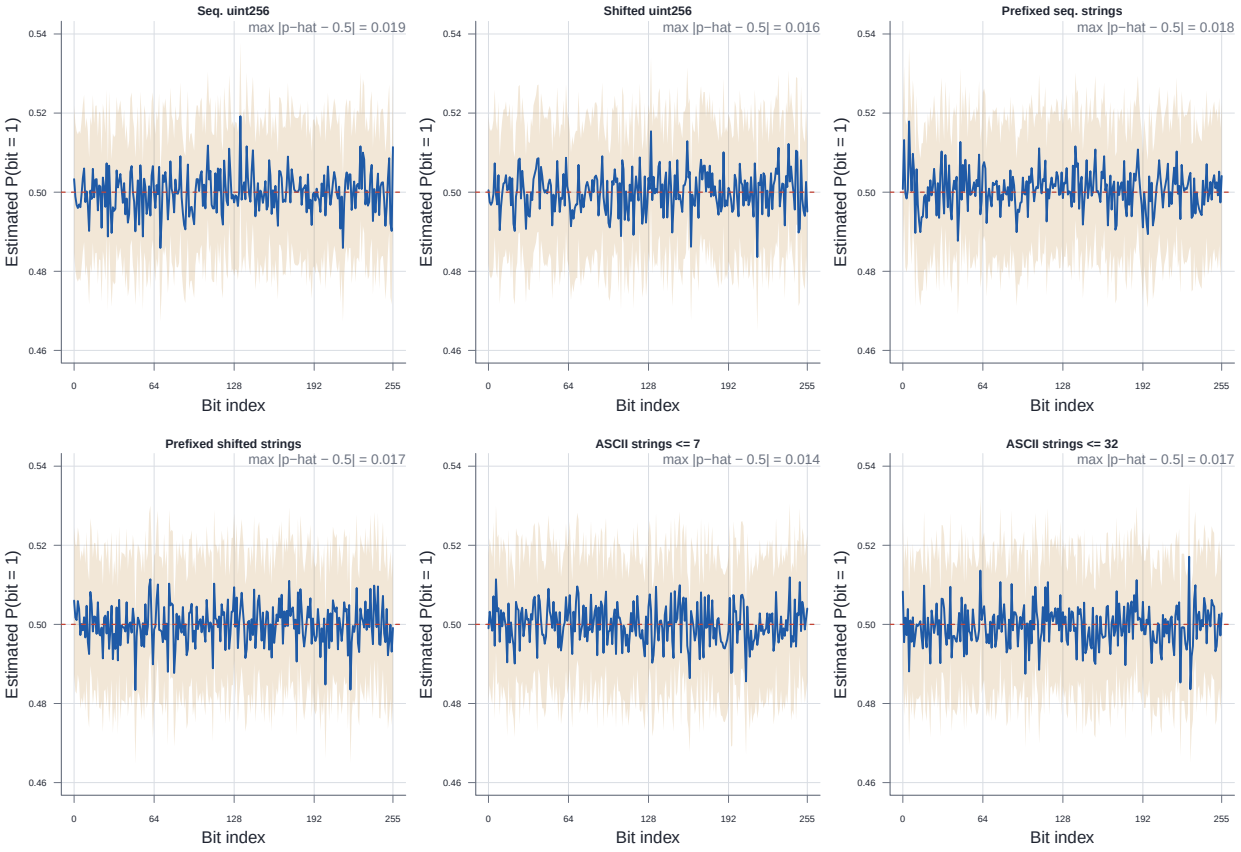


Figure 3: Bit-wise empirical means with Bonferroni-adjusted bands for the six one-shot input families.

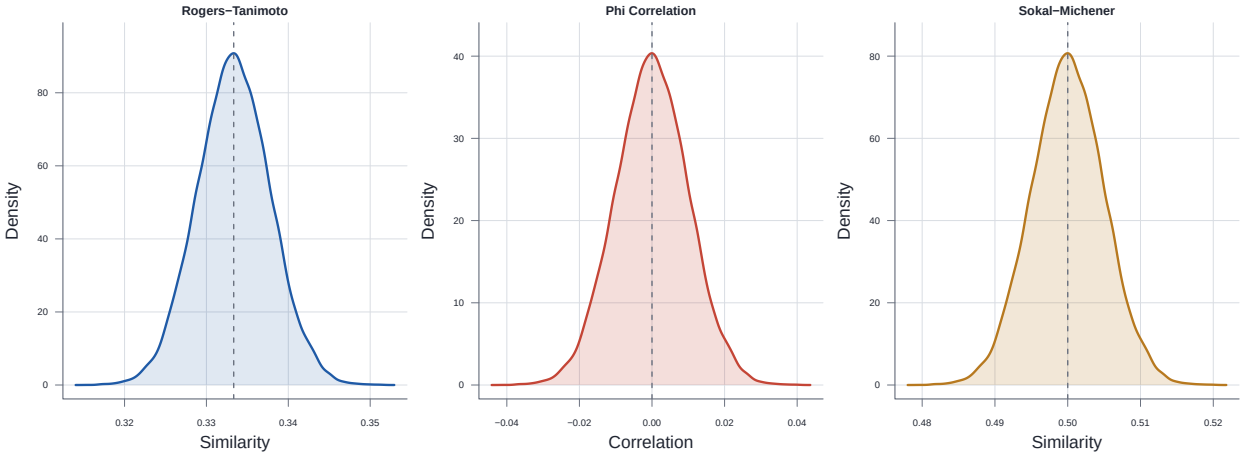


Figure 4: Pairwise similarity and correlation diagnostics for the baseline sequential integer experiment.

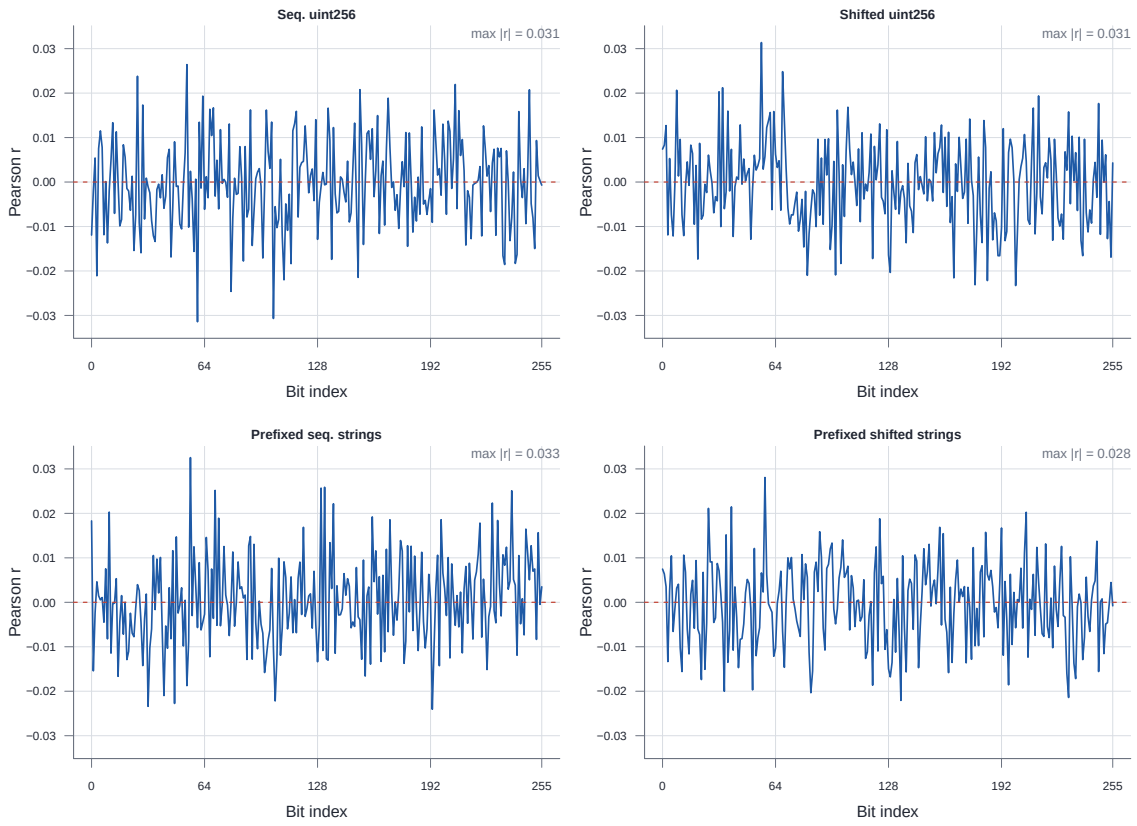


Figure 5: Pearson correlation between input index and each output bit for the sequential input families.

Figure 6 summarizes bit-level autocorrelation for lags 1 through 30 in the sequential experiments. The largest observed maximum absolute autocorrelation in the current run is below 0.044, again suggesting that simple short-lag structure is weak in the tested regimes.

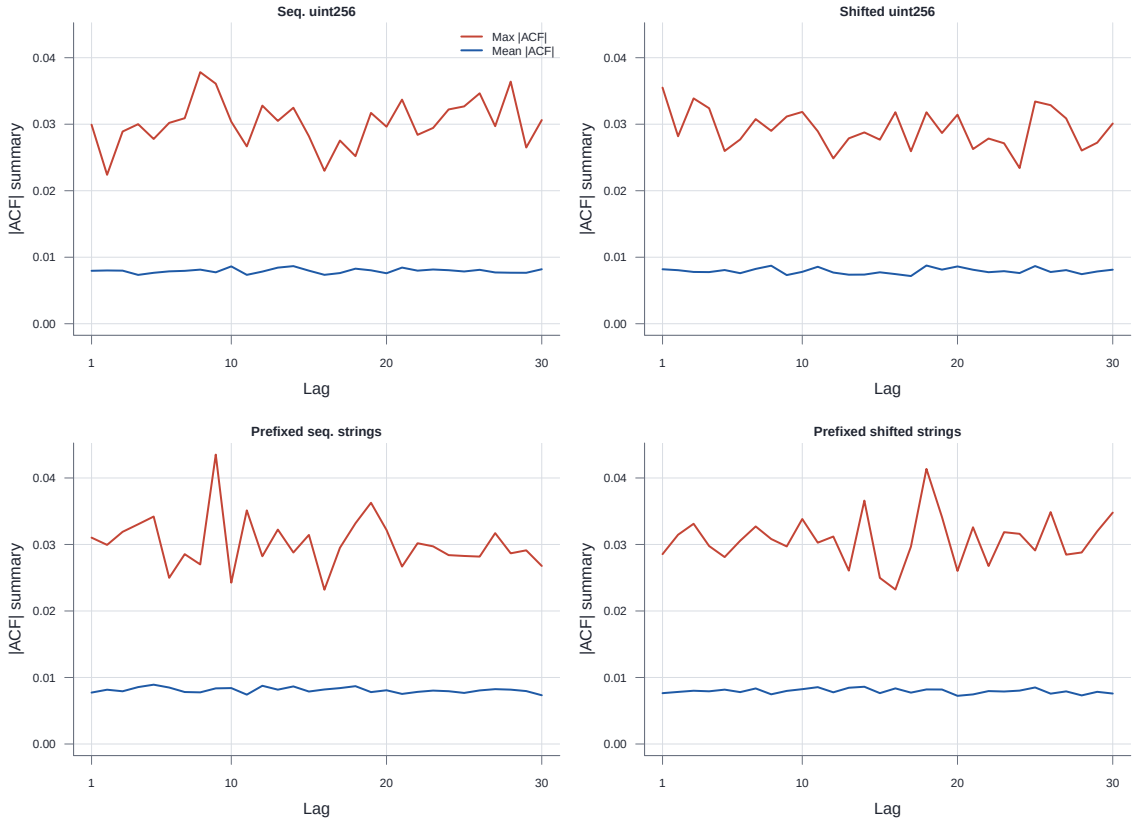


Figure 6: Mean and maximum absolute bit-level autocorrelation by lag for the sequential input families.

10 Normalization and Gaussian-Fit Diagnostics

The practical Solidity normalization is based on the fixed constants 128 and 8. By the corollary of Section 6, the quality of that normalization is governed by the summed bit bias $B_n = \hat{\mu} - 128$, where

$$\hat{\mu} = \sum_{i=1}^{256} \hat{p}_i, \qquad \hat{\sigma} = \sqrt{\sum_{i=1}^{256} \hat{p}_i(1 - \hat{p}_i)}$$

are the centering and scaling implied by the estimated marginals. Figure 7 and Table 5 report both, together with the standardized centering shift $(\hat{\mu} - 128)/8$. In the present run the largest $|\hat{\mu} - 128|$ is 0.171 (Experiment 2.1), which shifts the standardized output by 0.021 standard deviations; the other five families shift it by at most 0.014. The standard error of $\hat{\mu}$ at 10,000 draws is $8/\sqrt{10{,}000} = 0.08$, so the Experiment 2.1 value is a 2.1-standard-error fluctuation rather than a systematic offset; the 10^6-draw study of Section 10.1 confirms this, with $|\hat{\mu} - 128| \leq 0.011$ across all ten targets, a centering shift of at most 0.0014 standard deviations.

The implied scale $\hat{\sigma}$ equals 7.9996 in every family. That agreement is not evidence: as the corollary shows, it is forced by the smallness of the individual biases, and $\hat{\sigma}$ is computed under the independence assumption it might be hoped to test. The informative quantity is instead the ratio of the observed popcount variance s_S^2 to the independence-implied variance $\hat{\sigma}^2$, which equals 1 under independent bits and moves away from 1 if the bits are positively or negatively associated in a way that affects the sum. Table 5 reports this ratio; it lies between 0.988 and 1.017 across the six families. With 10,000 near-Gaussian samples the sampling standard deviation of a variance ratio is about $\sqrt{2/10{,}000} \approx 0.014$, so every observed ratio is within 1.2 standard errors of 1. This is a dependence check at the level of the statistic the sampler actually consumes, and it is the strongest evidence in the paper that the independence assumption behind the Poisson-binomial model is adequate for the Hamming weight.

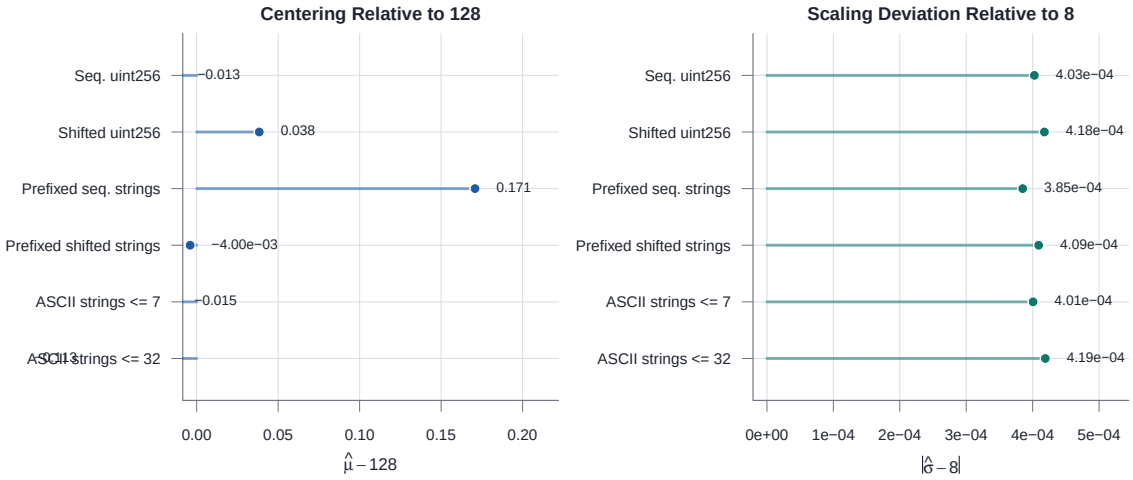


Figure 7: Empirical deviations of $(\hat{\mu}, \hat{\sigma})$ from the practical constants $(128, 8)$.

Experiment	$\hat{\mu}$	$\hat{\mu} - 128$	$(\hat{\mu} - 128)/8$	$\hat{\sigma}$	s_S	$s_S^2/\hat{\sigma}^2$
Experiment 1.1	127.9873	-0.0127	-0.0016	7.9996	7.9854	0.9964
Experiment 1.2	128.0384	0.0384	0.0048	7.9996	7.9520	0.9881
Experiment 2.1	128.1708	0.1708	0.0213	7.9996	8.0663	1.0167
Experiment 2.2	127.9960	-0.0040	-0.0005	7.9996	8.0182	1.0047
Experiment 3.1	127.9854	-0.0146	-0.0018	7.9996	7.9888	0.9973
Experiment 3.2	127.8874	-0.1126	-0.0141	7.9996	7.9731	0.9934

Table 5: Centering and scaling diagnostics for the six one-shot families. $\hat{\mu}$ and $\hat{\sigma}$ are the mean and standard deviation implied by the estimated bit probabilities under independence, $(\hat{\mu}-128)/8$ is the resulting shift of the standardized output, s_S is the observed standard deviation of the popcount, and $s_S^2/\hat{\sigma}^2$ is the variance ratio, which equals 1 under independent bits.

Figure 8 compares the empirical popcount CDF to the Gaussian CDF with mean 128 and standard deviation 8. The fit is already visually close. Figures 9 and 10 extend that comparison with QQ plots and two-sided tail probabilities for all six one-shot input families.

Table 6 summarizes the fit using the Kolmogorov-Smirnov and Wasserstein-1 distances to two references, the continuous $\mathcal{N}(128, 8^2)$ benchmark and the exact Binomial$(256, \frac{1}{2})$ law, together with skewness, excess kurtosis, and the absolute two-sided tail error at $z = 2$. Against the continuous

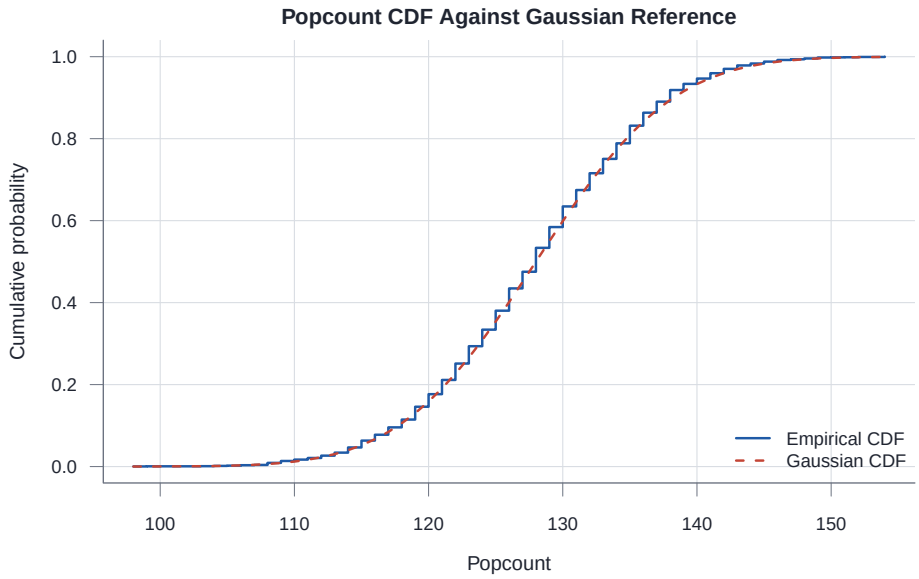


Figure 8: Empirical CDF of the popcount against the Gaussian CDF with mean 128 and standard deviation 8.

normal, the Kolmogorov-Smirnov distance lies between 0.028 and 0.036 and the Wasserstein distance between 0.25 and 0.29; the absolute tail error at $z = 2$ lies between 0.005 and 0.014.

Those continuous-reference distances are dominated by the lattice, not by the bits. The popcount takes integer values, so its CDF is a step function, and the Kolmogorov-Smirnov distance between the *exact* Binomial$(256, \frac{1}{2})$ law and $\mathcal{N}(128, 8^2)$, computed with the same two-sided convention, is already 0.0249; similarly, rounding a continuous variable to a unit lattice contributes about 0.25 to the Wasserstein distance. Once the reference is the exact binomial law, the Kolmogorov-Smirnov distance drops to between 0.004 and 0.012 and the Wasserstein distance to between 0.05 and 0.19. For comparison, the usual 5% critical value at 10,000 samples is $1.36/\sqrt{10000} = 0.0136$, so none of the six families rejects the exact fair-coin binomial law at that level, whereas all six would reject a continuous normal null, as any lattice variable must. The right reading of Table 6 is therefore that the Hamming weight of `keccak256` is compatible with the Hamming weight of fair independent bits, and that the residual distance to a continuous Gaussian is the discretization the on-chain application has already accepted.

The tail-error column carries the same kind of lattice offset. The two-sided tail is evaluated at $|S - 128| \geq 8z$, and on the lattice that event includes the atom at exactly $8z$, so the exact binomial tail is systematically heavier than the uncorrected Gaussian tail: 0.0525 against 0.0455 at $z = 2$, a gap of 0.007 that is present even for perfectly fair independent bits. Applying the usual continuity correction, that is, comparing with $2\big(1 - \Phi((8z - \frac{1}{2})/8)\big)$, reproduces the binomial tail to three decimals at every z from 1 to 4. The observed $|\Delta T_2|$ values of 0.005–0.014 in Table 6 are therefore mostly this offset, not a property of the bits.

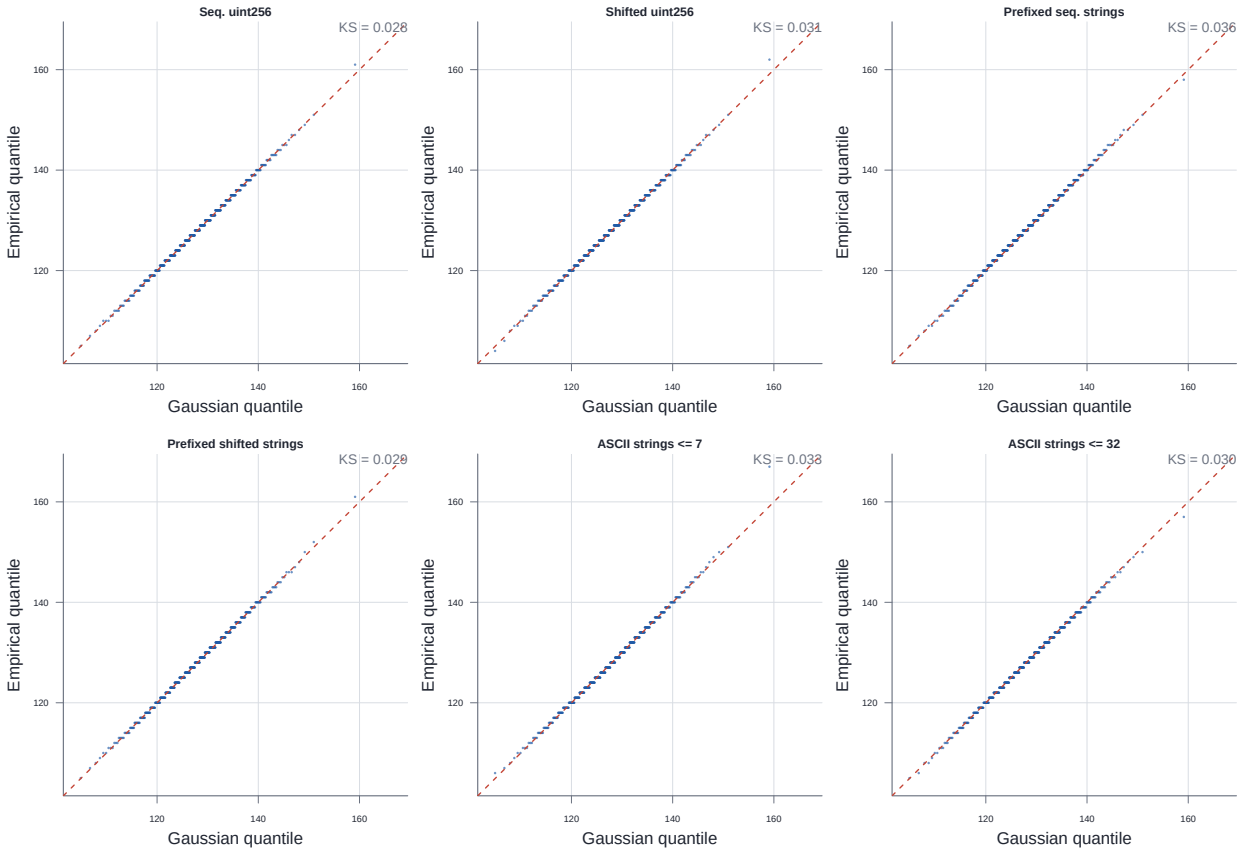


Figure 9: QQ diagnostics comparing empirical popcount quantiles to the quantiles of $N(128, 8^2)$.

Experiment	$\mathrm{KS}_{\mathcal{N}}$	$\mathrm{KS}_{\mathrm{Bin}}$	$W_1^{\mathcal{N}}$	W_1^{Bin}	Skewness	Excess Kurtosis	$\lvert\Delta T_2\rvert$
Experiment 1.1	0.0282	0.0036	0.2546	0.0490	0.0007	-0.0153	0.0069
Experiment 1.2	0.0311	0.0062	0.2624	0.0838	-0.0273	0.0419	0.0053
Experiment 2.1	0.0363	0.0117	0.2924	0.1927	-0.0137	0.0437	0.0141
Experiment 2.2	0.0288	0.0052	0.2591	0.0669	0.0019	0.0175	0.0060
Experiment 3.1	0.0329	0.0090	0.2684	0.0972	0.0602	0.0009	0.0055
Experiment 3.2	0.0302	0.0067	0.2695	0.1129	-0.0235	0.0000	0.0061

Table 6: Finite-sample distributional diagnostics for the popcount. $\mathrm{KS}_{\mathcal{N}}$ and $W_1^{\mathcal{N}}$ are distances to the continuous $\mathcal{N}(128, 8^2)$ benchmark; $\mathrm{KS}_{\mathrm{Bin}}$ and W_1^{Bin} are distances to the exact Binomial$(256, \frac{1}{2})$ law. The discreteness floor for $\mathrm{KS}_{\mathcal{N}}$ is 0.0249.

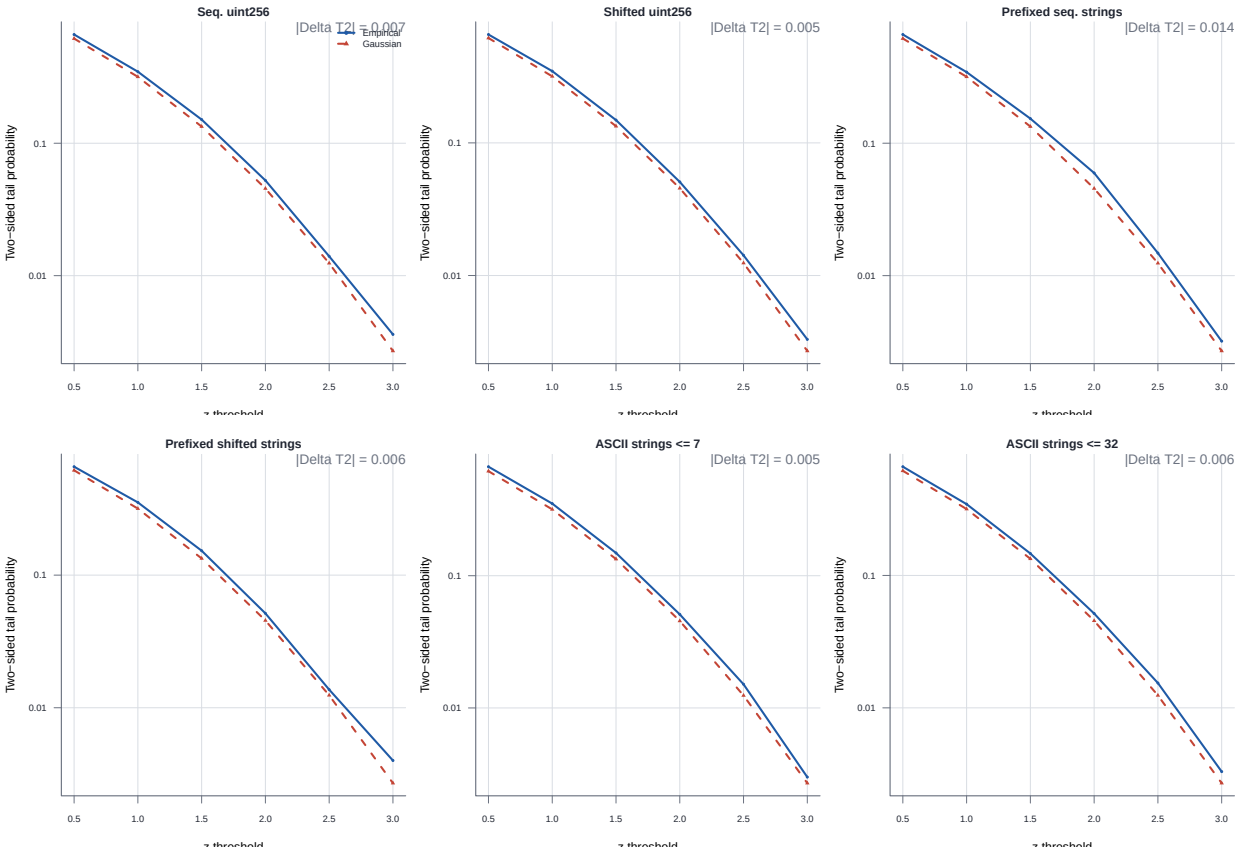


Figure 10: Empirical and Gaussian two-sided tail probabilities for the standardized popcount.

10.1 Tails at 10^6 draws

With 10,000 draws the two-sided Gaussian tail at $z = 3$ corresponds to about 27 draws and at $z = 4$ to fewer than one, so the diagnostics above say little about the extreme tails. To address this directly, a separate run draws 10^6 `keccak256` popcounts for each of the six one-shot families and each of the four repeated-hash chains, that is, 10^7 digests in total, and compares the tails against the exact binomial law. Table 7 reports the two-sided tail probabilities in units of 10^{-3} at $z = 1, \ldots, 4$, with the Gaussian and binomial references in the first two rows, and Table 8 the corresponding mean, standard deviation, and Kolmogorov-Smirnov distance to the binomial law.

Target	$z = 1$	$z = 1.5$	$z = 2$	$z = 2.5$	$z = 3$	$z = 3.5$	$z = 4$
Gaussian	317.311	133.614	45.500	12.419	2.700	0.465	0.063
Binomial(256, $\frac{1}{2}$)	348.521	150.435	52.472	14.628	3.231	0.561	0.076
Experiment 1.1	348.661	150.912	52.519	14.694	3.249	0.572	0.094
Experiment 1.2	348.176	150.262	51.972	14.444	3.197	0.543	0.080
Experiment 2.1	347.933	150.494	52.402	14.684	3.213	0.532	0.076
Experiment 2.2	348.794	150.657	52.784	14.808	3.264	0.558	0.076
Experiment 3.1	348.997	150.082	51.958	14.648	3.298	0.617	0.067
Experiment 3.2	348.316	150.217	51.965	14.632	3.285	0.568	0.075
Sequence 1	347.632	150.209	51.926	14.510	3.235	0.539	0.071
Sequence 2	348.127	150.600	52.666	14.691	3.278	0.548	0.086
Sequence 3	348.442	150.272	52.299	14.626	3.191	0.531	0.068
Sequence 4	348.262	149.639	52.209	14.597	3.276	0.580	0.082

Table 7: Two-sided tail probabilities $\mathbb{P}(|S - 128| \geq 8z)$ in units of 10^{-3} from 10^6 draws per target, against the continuous Gaussian and the exact Binomial(256, $\frac{1}{2}$) references. At $z = 4$ the binomial reference corresponds to 76 expected draws.

Target	Mean	SD	$\mathrm{KS}_{\mathrm{Bin}}$
Experiment 1.1	128.0048	8.0019	0.00081
Experiment 1.2	128.0051	7.9904	0.00060
Experiment 2.1	128.0090	7.9967	0.00077
Experiment 2.2	127.9986	8.0078	0.00074
Experiment 3.1	127.9893	7.9950	0.00114
Experiment 3.2	127.9907	7.9955	0.00091
Sequence 1	127.9983	7.9897	0.00059
Sequence 2	128.0111	8.0015	0.00093
Sequence 3	127.9995	7.9982	0.00074
Sequence 4	127.9944	7.9908	0.00067

Table 8: Mean, standard deviation, and Kolmogorov-Smirnov distance to the exact binomial law from 10^6 draws per target. The 5% critical value at this sample size is $1.36/\sqrt{10^6} = 0.00136$.

Every target tracks the binomial row, not the Gaussian row, at every threshold, including $z = 4$, where the observed counts range from 67 to 94 against 76 expected. Of the 70 target-by-threshold comparisons, seven exceed 1.96 binomial standard errors in absolute value and the largest is 2.45; the thresholds are nested within each target, so these comparisons are strongly correlated and a modest excess over the nominal 3.5 is not surprising, and the deviations show no consistent sign across thresholds. The Kolmogorov-Smirnov distance to the binomial law lies between 0.0006 and 0.0011 for all ten targets, below the 5% critical value of 0.00136 at this sample size, so none of them rejects the fair-coin binomial law even with a hundred times more data than the main study.

11 Repeated-Hash Sequence Diagnostics

The previous sections study isolated hash outputs. The actual generator, however, is consumed as a sequence. The next question is therefore whether the recursive map

$$H_{t+1} = \texttt{keccak256}(H_t)$$

introduces visible short-lag structure into the popcount sequence

$$S_t = \text{number of 1's in } H_t.$$

Figure 11 shows the autocorrelation of S_t for four representative repeated-hash chains and for lags 1 through 30. Figure 12 plots S_t against S_{t+1} for the same chains. The visual impression is that these chains do not display obvious short-lag structure. In the current run, the lag-1 correlation lies between roughly 0.001 and 0.018, while the maximum absolute autocorrelation through lag 30 lies between roughly 0.023 and 0.035.

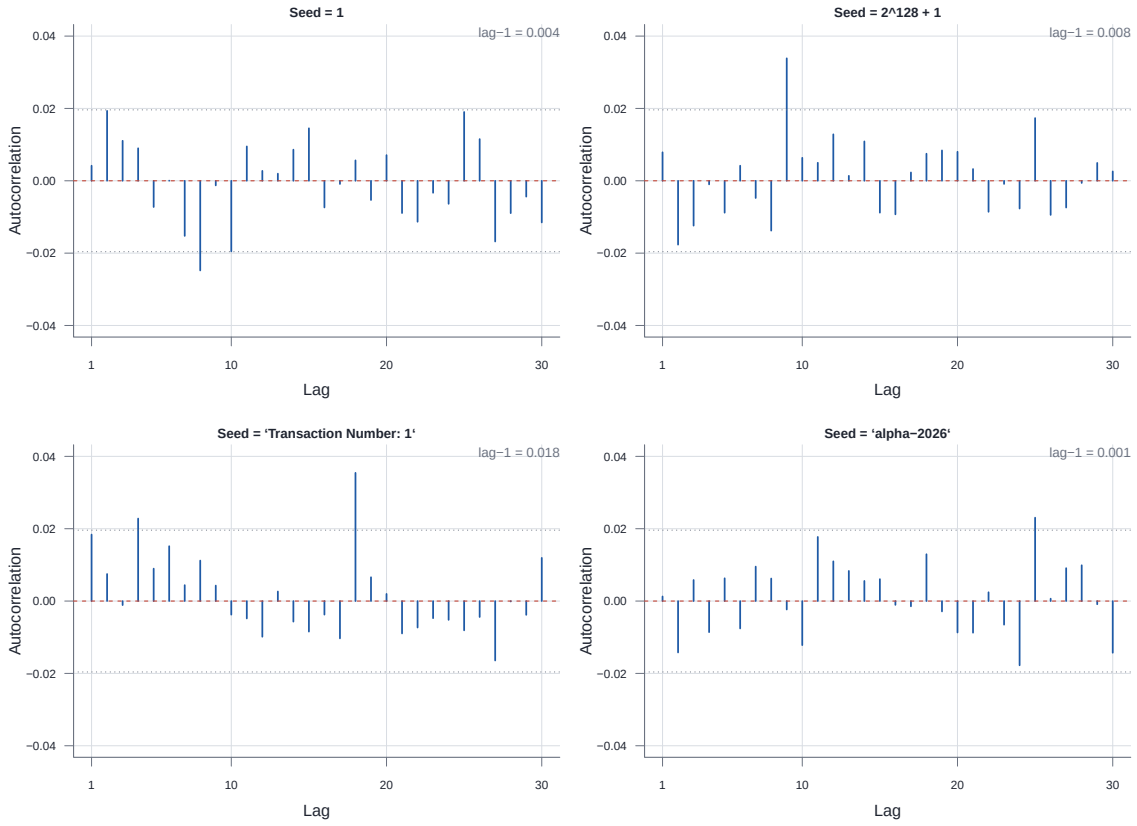


Figure 11: Autocorrelation of the popcount sequence for four repeated-hash chains.

Table 9 summarizes the same study by reporting the mean and standard deviation of the popcount sequence, the lag-1 correlation, the largest absolute autocorrelation up to lag 30, the runs-test z-score about the median 128, and the absolute two-sided tail error at $z = 2$. The runs-test z-scores lie between -1.50 and 0.78, and the tail errors between 0.003 and 0.008, which is again compatible with the absence of obvious short-lag dependence for the tested seeds.

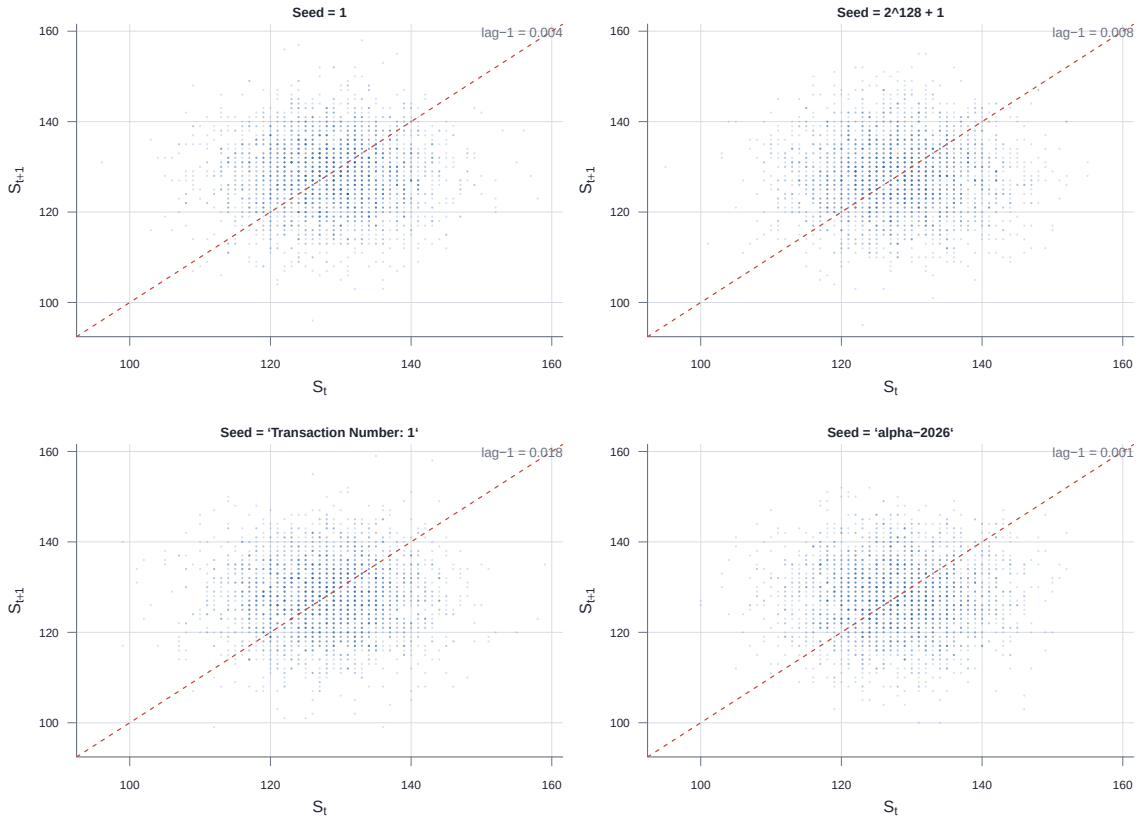


Figure 12: Lag-1 scatter plots for repeated-hash popcount sequences.

Sequence	Mean Count	SD Count	Lag-1 Corr	Max $\lvert\rho_h\rvert$	Runs z	$\lvert\Delta T_2\rvert$
Sequence 1	127.9579	7.9600	0.0042	0.0248	0.1287	0.0027
Sequence 2	128.0153	7.9580	0.0079	0.0339	-0.1537	0.0083
Sequence 3	128.0109	7.9452	0.0184	0.0354	-1.4950	0.0047
Sequence 4	127.8900	7.9386	0.0013	0.0230	0.7849	0.0068

Table 9: Summary diagnostics for repeated-hash popcount sequences.

12 On-Chain Implications

The practical interpretation of the numerical study is straightforward. If the bit probabilities remain close to 0.5, then the natural centering and scaling are already close to $(128, 8)$. If the popcount distribution is close to a Gaussian benchmark at $n = 256$, then the integer-scaled Solidity output

$$125S - 16000$$

is a plausible discrete approximation to a standard normal draw, represented at integer scale 1000.

The output is nevertheless a lattice-valued random variable, not a continuous normal draw, and the integer scale should not be mistaken for resolution. For $n = 256$ and $c = 1000$, adjacent possible outputs differ by 125, because changing the Hamming weight by one changes $125S - 16000$ by 125; the effective resolution is therefore 0.125 standard deviations, not 0.001, and the support is confined to $[-16, 16]$ standard deviations. Figure 13 shows this final integer-scaled distribution for a representative one-shot family. Doubling the width to $n = 512$ improves the resolution only to $2/\sqrt{512} \approx 0.088$; resolution improves as $2/\sqrt{n}$, so each additional decimal digit costs a hundredfold increase in width. This discreteness is usually acceptable for game mechanics, perturbations, and integer-valued smart-contract logic, but it should be kept explicit when an application requires a continuous or very fine-grained distribution.

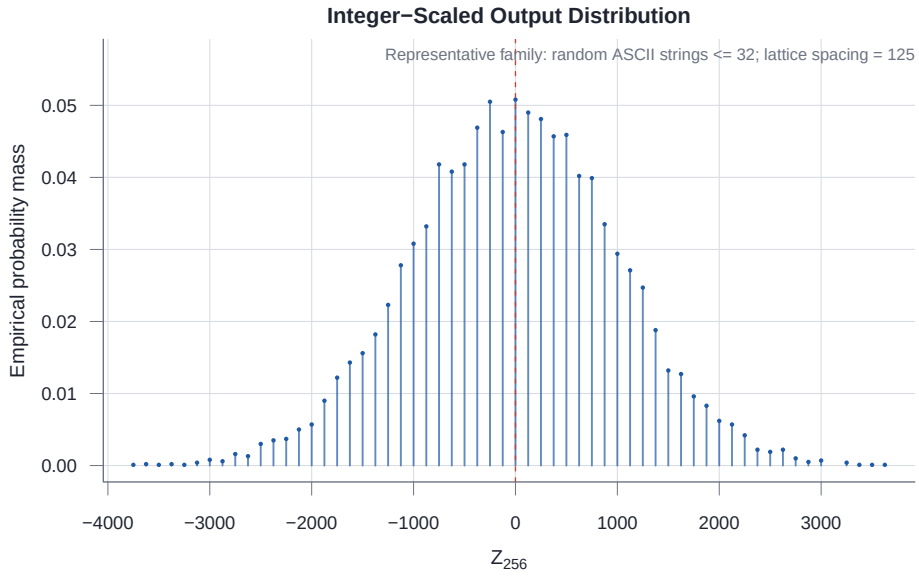


Figure 13: Empirical distribution of the final integer-scaled output $Z_{256,1000} = 125S - 16000$ for the random ASCII input family with length up to 32.

This approach is attractive on-chain because it avoids floating-point operations, trigonometric transforms, and expensive rejection samplers. The computation reduces to hashing and bit counting. A Box–Muller transform would require logarithms, square roots, and trigonometric functions, either natively or through approximations [1]. Ziggurat or other rejection-sampling approaches can avoid some transcendental work, but they introduce tables, branches, and a variable number of iterations [12]. The present method has a fixed execution shape once the entropy input is available,

provided the population count itself is implemented with a fixed instruction count: obtain one VM-native output, count its bits, and apply a small amount of integer arithmetic.

Table 10 reports the measured EVM gas for each stage, obtained with `gasleft()` deltas inside a single call over 2,000 chained `keccak256` digests (Foundry, `solc` 0.8.26 with the optimizer enabled, Cancun EVM). The choice of population-count algorithm matters more than everything else combined. The textbook Kernighan loop, which clears one set bit per iteration, averages 7,761 gas and ranges from 6,074 to 9,374 because its iteration count *is* the Hamming weight; it therefore also leaks the output value through gas consumption. A SWAR (SIMD-within-a-register) reduction computes the same count in 233 gas with no data dependence. With the SWAR count, one Gaussian draw costs about 530 gas in total, roughly 2.5% of the 21,000 base cost of a transaction, and about 15 times less than the loop-based variant. The price of this simplicity is that the distributional claim is only as strong as the probabilistic model and the empirical evidence supporting it.

Stage	Mean gas	Min	Max	Cost shape
`keccak256` of one 32-byte word	268	221	316	fixed (memory expansion)
popcount, Kernighan loop	7,761	6,074	9,374	one iteration per set bit
popcount, SWAR reduction	233	233	233	constant
integer scaling $125S - 16000$	29	29	29	constant

Table 10: Measured EVM gas per stage of the $n = 256$ transform over 2,000 chained digests. The base transaction cost and calldata are excluded.

Experiment	Max $\lvert\hat{p}_i - 0.5\rvert$	Mean Count	SD Count	Max $\lvert r\rvert$	Max $\lvert\rho_h\rvert$
Experiment 1.1	0.0192	127.9873	7.9854	0.0314	0.0378
Experiment 1.2	0.0164	128.0384	7.9520	0.0314	0.0355
Experiment 2.1	0.0179	128.1708	8.0663	0.0325	0.0435
Experiment 2.2	0.0166	127.9960	8.0182	0.0281	0.0414
Experiment 3.1	0.0144	127.9854	7.9888	–	–
Experiment 3.2	0.0171	127.8874	7.9731	–	–

Table 11: Summary diagnostics across the six one-shot experiments.

13 Scope and Limitations

The numerical study provides empirical support for the modeling assumptions, but it does not prove full joint independence of the output bits of `keccak256`, SHA-256, or any native randomness service. Lyapunov's theorem addresses non-identical Bernoulli marginals under independence. It does not justify the Gaussian approximation if genuine dependence among the bits is materially present.

The theorem is asymptotic, whereas the intended implementation uses fixed widths such as $n = 256$ and $n = 512$. The practical argument therefore depends on both the CLT heuristic and the finite-sample numerical diagnostics. Two further finite-sample caveats apply. The corollary shows that the centering error of the fixed normalization scales as $2B_n/\sqrt{n}$, so at a fixed level of systematic bit bias the error *grows* with width; a wider primitive improves resolution but does not automatically improve centering. And the tail evidence, while it now extends to $z = 4$ with 10^6 draws per target, stops there: at $z = 4$ the binomial reference is 76 expected draws, and the lattice support ends at $z = 16$, so the study makes no claim about tails beyond $z = 4$ or about the extreme atoms of the distribution. The repeated-hash study similarly addresses obvious short-lag

structure for a small set of representative seeds; it should not be read as a proof against all forms of long-range or adversarially chosen dependence.

The construction also assumes that the seed or VM-native randomness input is not freely grindable by an adversary. A party who can choose many candidate inputs and keep only those whose hash has a favorable Hamming weight can bias the output distribution. That is not a defect of the Hamming-weight transform itself; it is a trust-model requirement on the entropy source and input selection process. In adversarial settings, the seed should come from a VRF, beacon, native randomness service, commit–reveal protocol, or another mechanism that prevents unilateral post-hoc input selection.

Viewed through an information-theoretic lens, the Hamming-weight distribution checks whether the output has the composition expected from fair bits. It does not by itself certify the full entropy or independence structure of the bit string. This paper is therefore best read as an applied probabilistic construction with empirical validation. It is not a cryptographic security proof and it does not claim that the resulting generator is appropriate for every randomness-sensitive use case.

14 Conclusion

The clean statement supported by this paper is the following. Model the `keccak256` output bits as independent Bernoulli random variables with possibly different success probabilities p_i. Under that model, the popcount has a Poisson-binomial distribution, and Lyapunov's central limit theorem implies that the standardized count is asymptotically Gaussian. The numerical study then provides empirical support for the practical finite-sample approximation

$$\frac{S - 128}{8} \approx \mathcal{N}(0, 1),$$

which leads directly to the integer-scaled on-chain representation

$$125S - 16000.$$

The empirical evidence remains intentionally modest. It does not prove independence or certify the generator cryptographically. It does, however, make the working model substantially harder to dismiss. For the quantities the generator actually uses, namely the centering, the scaling, the popcount distribution, and the repeated-hash output sequence, the observed behavior of Keccak-256 and SHA-256 is indistinguishable from that of an iid fair-bit control run through the same pipeline: the summed bit bias shifts the output by at most 0.02 standard deviations, the popcount variance ratio is within sampling error of 1, and the distance to the exact binomial law is below the conventional critical value. The cross-VM study shows the same pattern for both hash primitives and for the controls at 256 and 512 bits, which supports the interpretation of the method as a portable distribution-shaping layer rather than a chain-specific trick, and the gas measurements show that, with a constant-time population count, that layer costs a few hundred gas per draw.

Data and Code Availability

Every hash, statistic, table, and figure in this paper is generated deterministically from the fixed seed `20260415` by the scripts in the public repository `https://github.com/simontianx/OnChainRNG`, directory `GaussianRNG/docs/NumericalStudy`, whose three scripts produce the main study, the cross-VM study, and the 10^6-draw tail study respectively; the Keccak-256 implementation used there is checked against a reference test vector at start-up. The EVM gas benchmark of Table 10

is a Foundry project in `GaussianRNG/benchmarks`, and a Solidity reference implementation of the $n = 256$ generator with the SWAR population count is in `GaussianRNG/contracts`.

Declaration of Competing Interest

The author declares no known competing financial interests or personal relationships that could have appeared to influence the work reported in this paper.

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CRediT Authorship Contribution Statement

Simon Tian: Conceptualization, Methodology, Software, Formal analysis, Investigation, Writing – original draft, Writing – review & editing.

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